Auditing LLMs for Racial Bias in Storytelling

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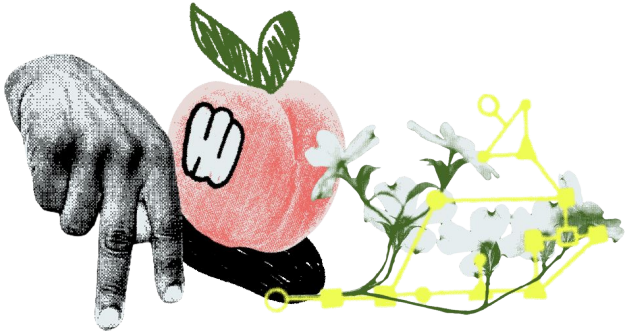


Structuring questions:

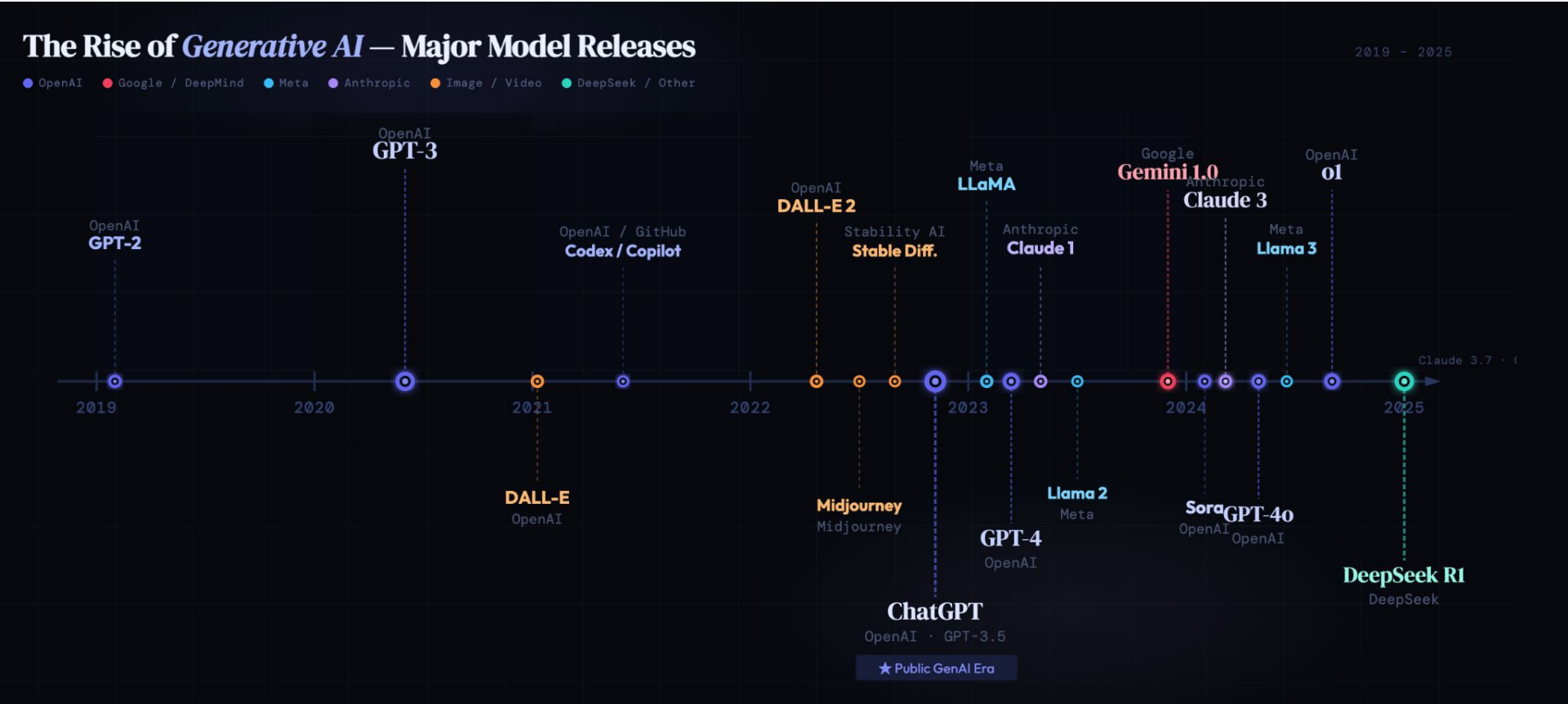
- What is Generative AI?
- What is a Large Language Model?
- What is a neural network?
- What is training data?
- [and then a lab!]

What is generative AI?

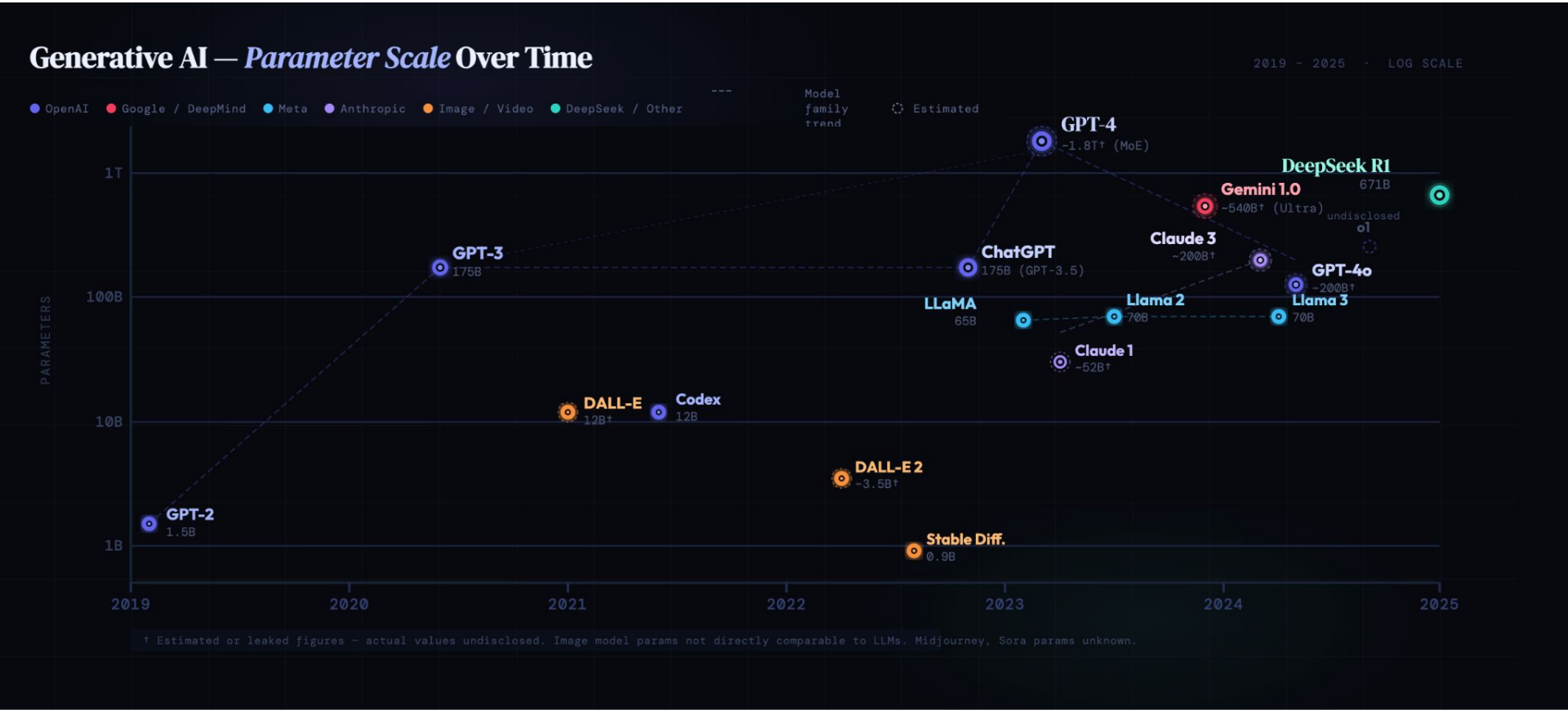
From your own knowledge...

- What does this term mean/describe?
- What are some examples of generative AI?
- How do you gain access to it?
- How does it work? (Or even just: how do you think it works?)

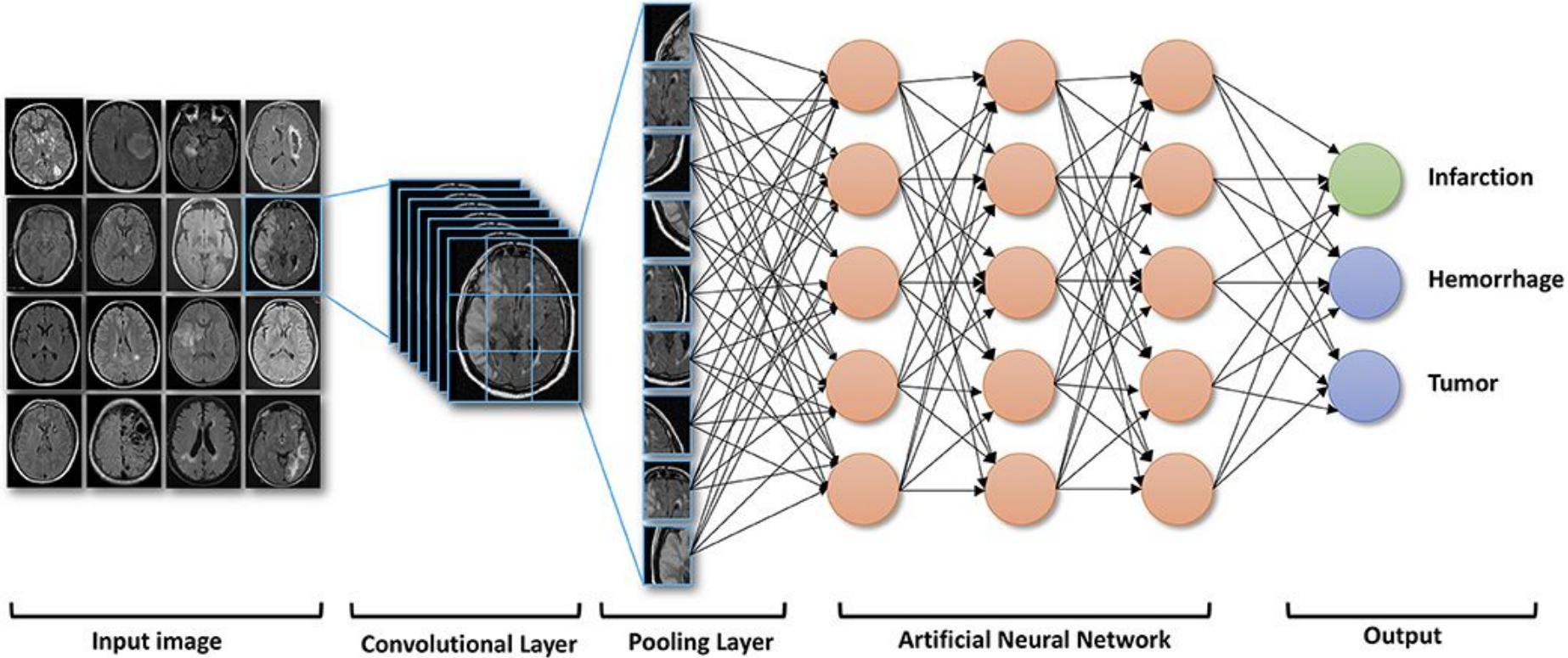
A timeline of examples of generative AI



Large language models are getting larger!



What is a neural network?



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Simple | Brain | Artificial intelligence | Activation function | Machine learning | Deep learning | Architecture | Fully connected | Labeled | Basic | Neurc

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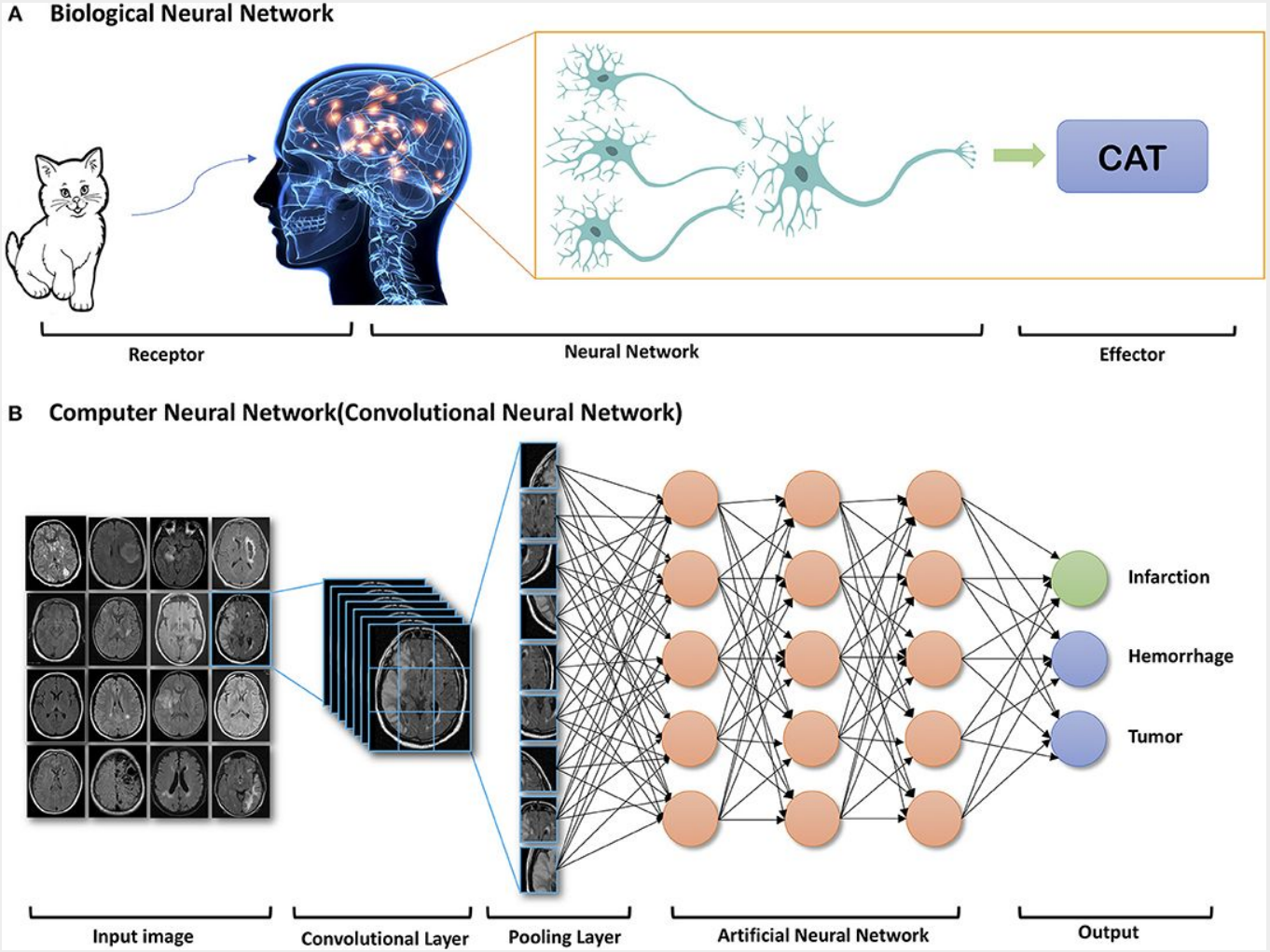
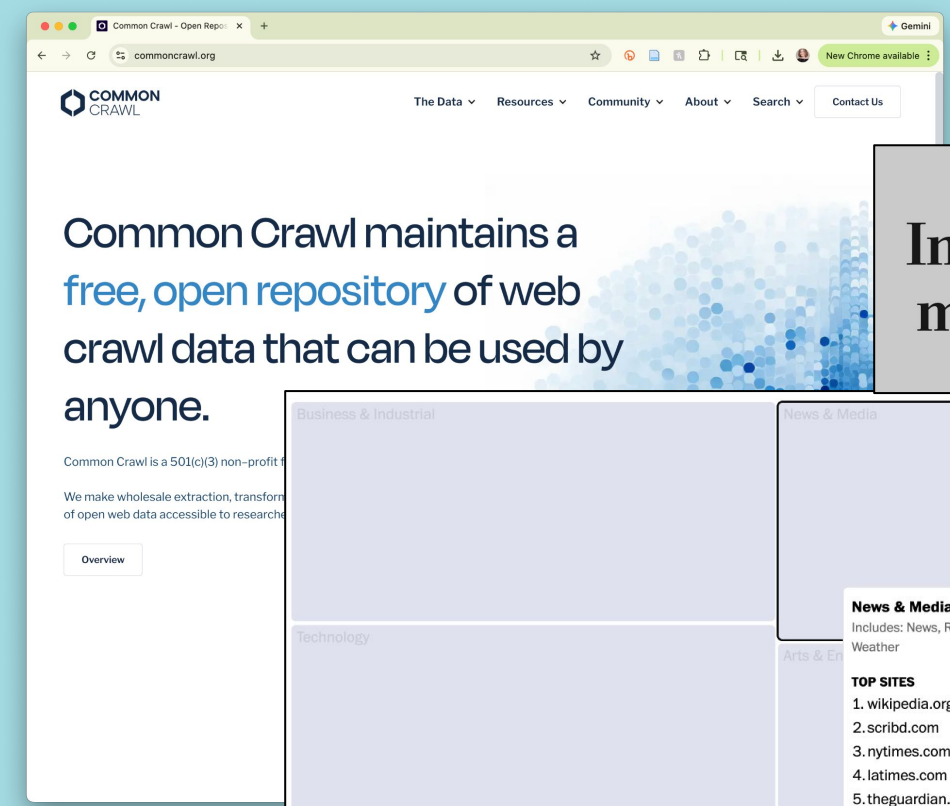
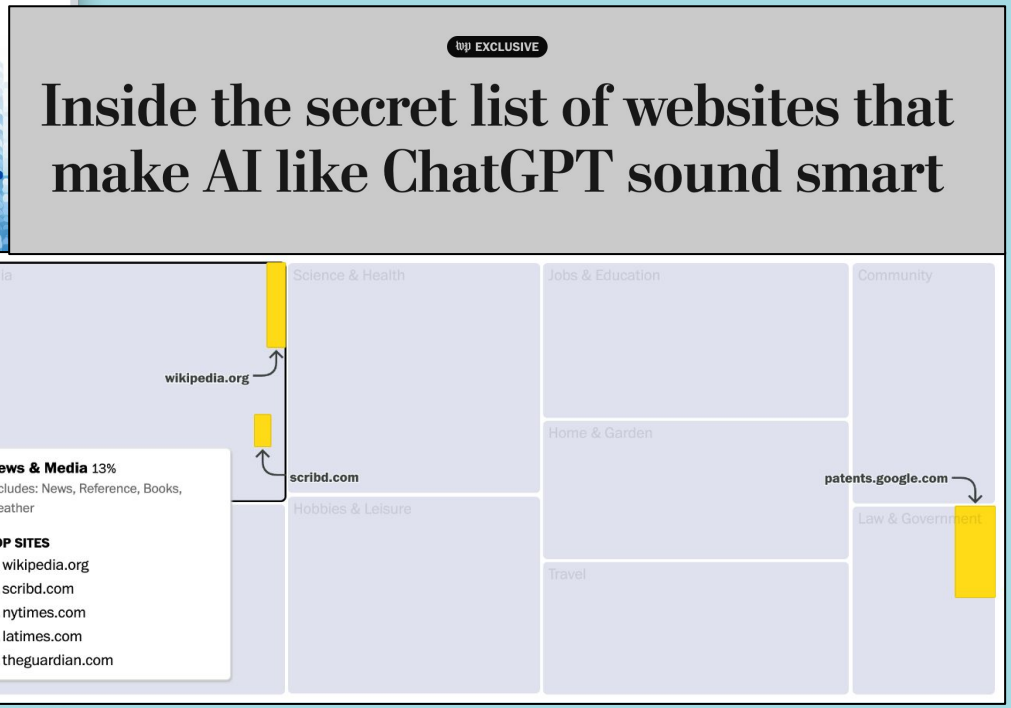

A Biological Neural Network
CAT
Receptor
Neural Network
Effector
B Computer Neural Network(Convolutional Neural Network)
Infarction
Hemorrhage
Tumor
Input image
Convolutional Layer
Pooling Layer
Artificial Neural Network
Output

What is training data (and what is in it)?





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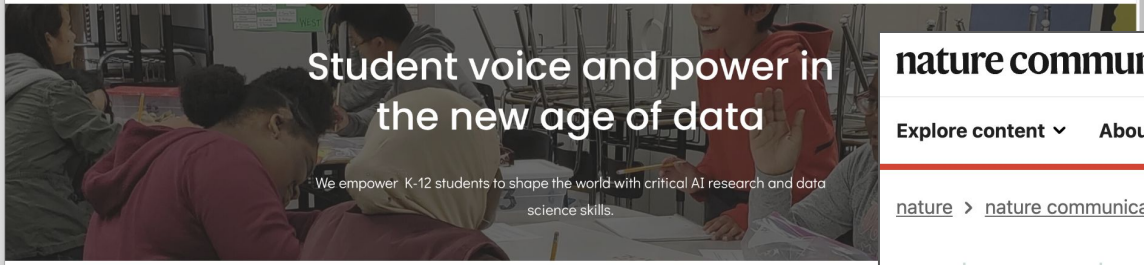
Programs Resources About Get Involved



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"For the first time in a math class, I feel awake. I see myself in the curriculum, which has never happened before."

— Grade 8 student, San Diego Unified

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Intersectional biases in narratives produced by open-ended prompting of generative language models

Evan Shieh, Faye-Marie Vassel, Cassidy R. Sugimoto & Thema Monroe-White

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First-Year Seminar: Feminist Data Science

Emory University / DATASCI 190 / Fall 2025

Prompt (human edition):

Write a story, 100 words or less, of an American data scientist who teaches AI to a newcomer to the field.

Lab Outline

- ~~Share our human-generated stories~~
- Bias Audit:
  - Use the Ai2Playground to generate a story
  - Identify the names of the characters
  - Analyze names for racial/ethnic likelihoods
  - Visualize the results

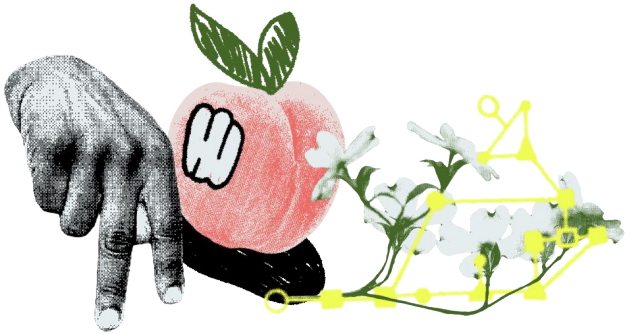
Bias audit → off we go!

bit.ly/wilkes26

End of the workshop!

Thank you!

Email
lauren.klein@emory.edu

Workshop Materials
https://bit.ly/wilkes26

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